# Palette

Fourth iteration of Margin's colour. The hues stay: white pages, ink-tinted greys, and fountain-pen blue. The system underneath is new.

### One hue for every grey

Desk, rules, borders, and text are all ink-tinted slate at hue 266, the accent's hue. Before, greys drifted between 258 and 268, so the page and its ink did not quite agree.

### Ramps built in OKLCH

Five ramps of twelve steps share one lightness scale, so blue 700, red 700, and green 700 carry equal visual weight. Tokens point at ramp steps.

### Borders that pass

Input, checkbox, and radio outlines get their own token at 3.2:1 or more, meeting WCAG 1.4.11. The old rule colour (1.4:1) remains for dividers only.

### A calmer correction red

Red moves from 29 to 32 degrees and loses some chroma: closer to an editor's pencil, further from an alarm.

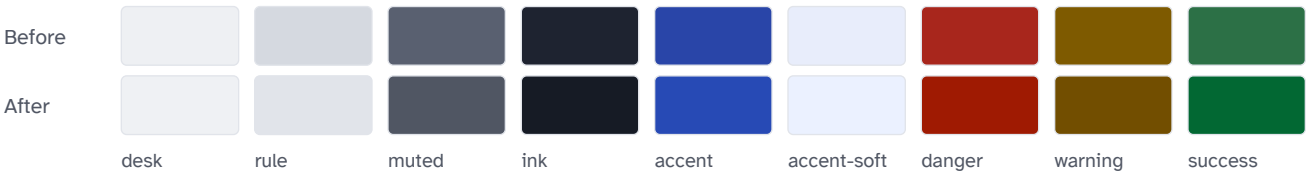
### Soft tints and selection

Each status has a soft tint for the note in focus. Text selection and token underlines get their own tokens.

### Dark mode from the same ramps

Dark tokens are the same ramps read from the other end, re-checked for contrast. Soft tints in dark mode use lower chroma so selected rows do not glow.

## Before and after




Added: border, accent-strong, accent-line, warning-soft, success-soft, selection.

# Ramps

Twelve steps from 50 to 975. Each step has the same OKLCH lightness in every ramp; chroma peaks near the step used for text.

| | 50 | 100 | 200 | 300 | 400 | 500 | 600 | 700 | 800 | 900 | 950 | 975 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Slate, hue 266** | F6F7FB | EFF1F4 | E1E4EA | CED2DA | AAAFB9 | 878C98 | 696F7C | 505663 | 3A404D | 262B37 | 161B25 | 0E111A |
| **Ink, hue 266** | F4F7FE | EBF1FF | D8E4FE | BDD1FE | 89ACFE | 6087E8 | 4066CF | 274AB5 | 163196 | 091B75 | 030957 | 020540 |
| **Correction, hue 32** | FEF5F3 | FFECE8 | FEDBD3 | FFC0B3 | F58E7A | D76550 | BA3F2A | 9F1A02 | 781101 | 560800 | 390300 | 290200 |
| **Query, hue 78** | FCF7EF | FEEED7 | FBE0B7 | F0CC95 | D1A763 | B2832F | 916506 | 724E00 | 563A01 | 3B2700 | 271800 | 1B0F00 |
| **Settled, hue 152** | F3F9F4 | E1F8E6 | C9EFD2 | ADE0BA | 82C092 | 579E6C | 2F814C | 026833 | 004E24 | 013517 | 00220D | 001707 |

### Lightness scale (OKLCH L)

50 0.98  100 0.96  200 0.92  300 0.86  400 0.75  500 0.64
600 0.54  700 0.45  800 0.37  900 0.29  950 0.22  975 0.18

### How to read the ramps

- Steps 50 to 200 are surfaces and tints. 300 to 500 are lines and dark-mode text. 600 to 800 are light-mode text and fills.
- Step 700 is the light-mode text step for every coloured ramp; step 300 is its dark-mode counterpart.

- Steps 900 to 975 of the coloured ramps are reserved. They are too saturated for surfaces; dark tints are set separately at low chroma.

# Tokens, light

Semantic tokens and the ramp step each one uses. Components use tokens, never ramp steps.

**page**
#FFFFFF white
Pages, inputs, menus

**desk**
#EFF1F4 slate 100
Application ground, disabled fills

**rule**
#E1E4EA slate 200
Dividers and hairlines only

**border**
#818895 solved for 3.2:1
Outlines of inputs, checkboxes, radios

**muted**
#505663 slate 700
Secondary text, placeholders, hints

**ink**
#161B25 slate 950
Text, headings, icons, graph lines

**accent**
#274AB5 ink 700
Links, primary actions, focus, trace

**accent-strong**
#163196 ink 800
Primary hover and pressed

**accent-soft**
#EBF1FF ink 100
Selected rows, tokens, active nav

**accent-line**
#BDD1FE ink 300
Token underlines at rest, rule ticks

**danger**
#9F1A02 red 700
Errors and destructive actions only

**danger-soft**
#FEF5F3 red 50
Behind an error note in focus

**warning**
#724E00 ochre 700
Warnings

**warning-soft**
#FCF7EF ochre 50
Behind a warning note in focus

**success**
#026833 green 700
Saved, valid, published

**success-soft**
#F3F9F4 green 50
Behind a success message

**selection**
#D8E4FE ink 200
Selected text

# Tokens, dark

Semantic tokens and the ramp step each one uses. Components use tokens, never ramp steps.

**page**
#262B37 slate 900
Pages, inputs, menus

**desk**
#161B25 slate 950
Application ground, disabled fills

**rule**
#3A404D slate 800
Dividers and hairlines only

**border**
#717784 solved for 3.2:1
Outlines of inputs, checkboxes, radios

**muted**
#AAAFB9 slate 400
Secondary text, placeholders, hints

**ink**
#F6F7FB slate 50
Text, headings, icons, graph lines

**accent**
#BDD1FE ink 300
Links, primary actions, focus, trace

**accent-strong**
#D8E4FE ink 200
Primary hover and pressed

**accent-soft**
#29395F custom, low chroma
Selected rows, tokens, active nav

**accent-line**
#566FAC custom, low chroma
Token underlines at rest, rule ticks

**danger**
#FFC0B3 red 300
Errors and destructive actions only

**danger-soft**
#462620 custom, low chroma
Behind an error note in focus

**warning**
#F0CC95 ochre 300
Warnings

**warning-soft**
#3B2E18 custom, low chroma
Behind a warning note in focus

**success**
#ADE0BA green 300
Saved, valid, published

**success-soft**
#203626 custom, low chroma
Behind a success message

**selection**
#314578 custom, low chroma
Selected text

# Contrast

Every text pairing meets WCAG AA; body text meets AAA. Control outlines meet the 3:1 non-text minimum on both page and desk.

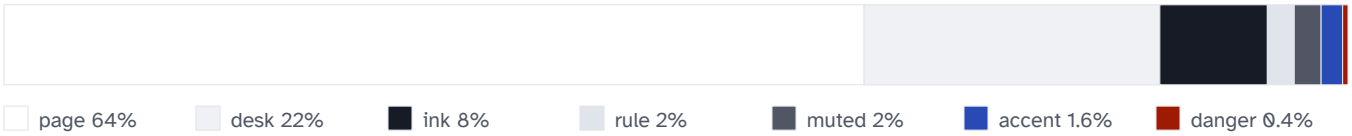
| Pairing | Minimum | Light | Dark | Use |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| a ink on page | 7:1 | **17.2:1** | **13.2:1** | body text |
| a ink on desk | 7:1 | **15.2:1** | **16.1:1** | text on desk |
| a muted on page | 4.5:1 | **7.4:1** | **6.4:1** | secondary text |
| a muted on desk | 4.5:1 | **6.5:1** | **7.8:1** | secondary text on desk |
| a accent on page | 4.5:1 | **7.7:1** | **9.2:1** | links, quiet buttons |
| a accent on accent-soft | 4.5:1 | **6.8:1** | **7.4:1** | selected tokens |
| a page on accent | 4.5:1 | **7.7:1** | **9.2:1** | primary button label |
| a page on accent-strong | 4.5:1 | **11.0:1** | **11.1:1** | primary button hover |
| a danger on page | 4.5:1 | **8.0:1** | **9.1:1** | error text |
| a danger on danger-soft | 4.5:1 | **7.5:1** | **8.6:1** | error on soft |
| a warning on page | 4.5:1 | **7.5:1** | **9.3:1** | warning text |
| a success on page | 4.5:1 | **6.9:1** | **9.5:1** | success text |
| a border on page | 3:1 | **3.6:1** | **3.2:1** | control outlines (WCAG 1.4.11) |
| a border on desk | 3:1 | **3.2:1** | **3.8:1** | control outlines on desk |
| a accent on page | 3:1 | **7.7:1** | **9.2:1** | focus ring |
| a ink on selection | 7:1 | **13.5:1** | **8.7:1** | selected text |
| a warning on warning-soft | 4.5:1 | **7.0:1** | **8.7:1** | warning on soft |
| a success on success-soft | 4.5:1 | **6.5:1** | **8.7:1** | success on soft |
| a muted on accent-soft | 4.5:1 | **6.5:1** | **5.2:1** | secondary text in selected row |

### Not text, so no minimum

Page against desk (1.1:1) and rule against page (1.3:1) separate surfaces and divide sections; they carry no information on their own. Anything a person must see to use a control (outlines, focus, checked states) uses border, accent, or ink.

# Proportion and use

Colour is rare by design. Most of any screen is page and desk; ink carries the words; blue marks what can be acted on; status colours appear only where a note says so.




| | |
|---|---|
| **Blue means you can act** | Links, the primary button, focus, selected items, and underlined tokens. Never used for decoration, headings, or illustration. |
| **One primary button per view** | The filled accent button marks the one main action. Everything else is secondary or quiet. |
| **Red only corrects** | Errors and destructive actions. Not for badges, counts, or emphasis. |
| **Tints follow focus** | A soft status tint appears behind a note only while that note or its field is in focus. |
| **Tokens underline in accent-line** | Underlined references rest in the lighter accent-line and turn accent on hover and focus. |
| **The trace is blue** | Playtest trace notes use accent, tying them to the interactive layer and keeping red for errors. |
| **Players are named, not coloured** | The play log sets players apart by name and indentation. There are no per-player colours. |
| **Narration is ink** | Model narration and authored text are both ink. Provenance is shown by placement and voice, not tint. |

# Colour vision

Simulated with the Machado, Oliveira, and Fernandes (2009) model at full severity. The three status colours converge for protanopia and deuteranopia, so every status also has a shape.

| | Typical | Protanopia | Deuteranopia | Tritanopia |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Error** | ! #9F1A02 | ! #473E00 | ! #675B00 | ! #B00018 |
| **Warning** | ○ #724E00 | ○ #5C4F00 | ○ #645804 | ○ #7D4441 |
| **Hint** | ／ #505663 | ／ #525764 | ／ #505563 | ／ #4B595A |
| **Trace** | 1 #274AB5 | 1 #005AB9 | 1 #004DB3 | 1 #006578 |

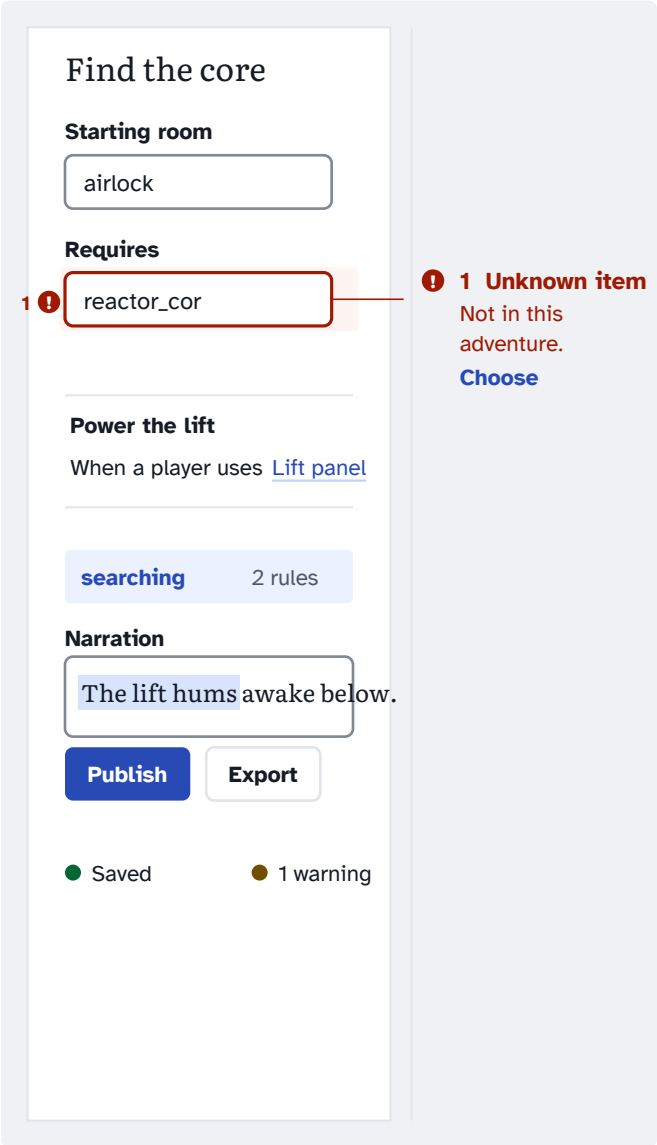
### Success and danger



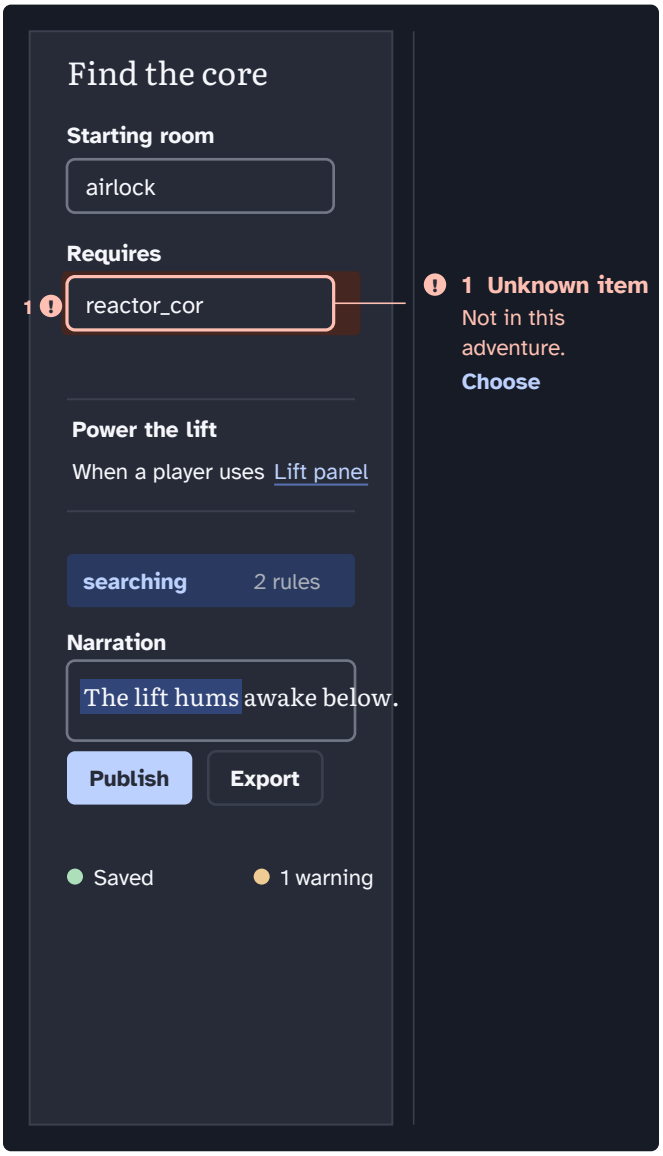

Status is always a shape or word plus colour: the note glyph, the status dot with its label, and the anchor bar beside a field with its numbered gutter mark. Removing every colour from a screen should lose no information.

# Applied

The same fragment of the adventure editor in both modes.




Light




Dark

# Tailwind

Tokens as CSS variables in Tailwind v4 @theme, in hex for broad support. The OKLCH source values are kept in palette.py so ramps can be regenerated.

```
@theme {
  --color-page: #FFFFFF;
  --color-desk: #EFF1F4;
  --color-rule: #E1E4EA;
  --color-border: #818895;
  --color-muted: #505663;
  --color-ink: #161B25;
  --color-accent: #274AB5;
  --color-accent-strong: #163196;
  --color-accent-soft: #EBF1FF;
  --color-accent-line: #BDD1FE;
  --color-danger: #9F1A02;
  --color-danger-soft: #FEF5F3;
  --color-warning: #724E00;
  --color-warning-soft: #FCF7EF;
  --color-success: #026833;
  --color-success-soft: #F3F9F4;
  --color-selection: #D8E4FE;
}
```

```
@media (prefers-color-scheme: dark) {
  :root:not([data-theme=light]) {
    --color-page: #262B37;
    --color-desk: #161B25;
    --color-rule: #3A404D;
    --color-border: #717784;
    --color-muted: #AAAFB9;
    --color-ink: #F6F7FB;
    --color-accent: #BDD1FE;
    --color-accent-strong: #D8E4FE;
    --color-accent-soft: #29395F;
    --color-accent-line: #566FAC;
    --color-danger: #FFC0B3;
    --color-danger-soft: #462620;
    --color-warning: #F0CC95;
    --color-warning-soft: #3B2E18;
    --color-success: #ADE0BA;
    --color-success-soft: #203626;
    --color-selection: #314578;
  }
}
```

**Theme switch**

Settings offers System, Light, and Dark. System follows prefers-color-scheme; the others set data-theme on the root element. The choice is stored per user.